



tournaments, after which the Ranji Trophy knockout starts. The rhythm and momentum get destroyed. Why is the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy not played till the quarterfinal, then a break for a few weeks, and then the semifinals and final, as it happens with the Ranji Trophy? It won't be done because the auction for the IPL happens pretty soon after the tournament. So the tournament runs till the end instead. As if having the tournament at the start of the season in September will make a difference to the franchise scouts who will be keenly watching the tournament — they won't forget the performers even if the auction happens a couple of months later.

Yes, it's understood that it's virtually impossible to play in the northern part of our country from mid-December to almost the end of January because of the winter dew factor, but those games can be scheduled in parts

Breaking new ground: Jammu & Kashmir won its maiden Ranji Trophy title last season, showcasing the emergence of new frontiers in Indian cricket. K. MURALI KUMAR

where the weather will be more amenable to playing.

In the old BCCI, there used to be a Technical Committee and a Fixtures Committee too. Experienced former players, umpires and administrators served on these committees, ensuring that cricket went smoothly.

Something similar needs to be done, drawing on such experience and expertise. The Indian cricket ecosystem is slightly skewed at the moment, and this would help rebalance it.

This way there's a good chance that the unending season for Indian cricket finds a stop sign and gives the players a chance to get out of the whirlpool which engulfs them now.

Ignoring domestic cricket to focus on international cricket will prove counterproductive in the end. Most importantly, if red-ball cricket is neglected, then the chances of producing top-class players will reduce considerably.